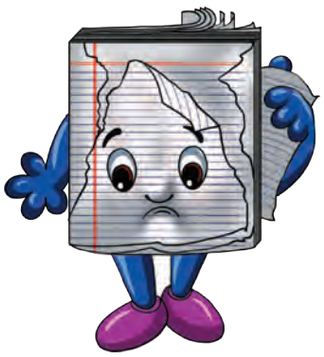
"Do go on!" prompted Justice Mathematics gently.



The Master Notebook got hold over himself and continued, "It started a few weeks back. Mahesh was solving some problems in Mathematics, one of them was tougher than others and he failed to solve it. Can you imagine how he vented his anger? Well, he threw me against the wall!"

A shock wave rent the courtroom and everybody started talking at once. Justice Mathematics went red with anger as he banged the hammer loudly, and you could see that he was wishing that the table were Mahesh. Mahesh, meanwhile, stared at his boots. Was he really that cruel? He felt really ashamed of himself.

"I intensely dislike such children who do not take proper care of their books," Justice Mathematics said in a serious voice, all the while eyeing Mahesh sternly.

"However, this court is different from the other courts. Here the punishment is decided by the victims and we decide by majority if the **verdicts** are more than one."

He looked at all the **bedraggled** books and notebooks, pencils and pencil box, and the school bag in the court.



They, in turn looked at Mahesh, each and every one of them in terrible anger. Mahesh trembled in his shoes.

"Let us thrash him first and then throw him against the wall as he threw me!" this was the Master Notebook, his voice shrill with fury.

"No! No! Let us all bite him and let him see how it feels to be chewed!" This obviously was Mr. Pencil Box.

He became so **agitated** that he once again opened himself and spilled some more pencil shavings on the floor!

"I suggest dragging him around the courtroom a dozen times will be a good punishment," said Mr. School Bag.

"Why don't we all jump on him together till he yells for mercy?" exclaimed Mr. Geography, rubbing his hands in **anticipation**.

This appealed to all of them and even Justice Mathematics got up from his chair to join the gang! **Menacingly** they all advanced towards Mahesh, who looked around **frantically** for somewhere to run to, somewhere to hide... Nothing! There was no place to run to! The mob was almost upon him when a soft voice rose above the frightening silence.

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